VeliD Advisory — Brand Guide

Positioning, voice, visual identity & messaging

VeliD Advisory · Prepared by Carin Verbree · September 2026

This guide captures how VeliD Advisory looks, sounds and explains itself, so every page, deck and conversation says the same thing in the same voice.

Who VeliD Advisory is

VeliD Advisory is Carin Verbree's strategy and sustainability advisory. It helps ambitious SMEs grow across borders, starting between the Netherlands and Mexico, with Southern France and Spain next.

The name

VeliD combines Carin's surname, Verbree, with the first names of her two children. It is a personal name, not a category label, and that is deliberate. The firm is built on twenty years of lived experience, not on a generic formula that could belong to anyone.

The tagline

Growth that lasts. In full: Helping companies build international growth that lasts. It says what the firm is for in plain words, without borrowing the language of compliance or the vagueness of "making the world better."

"I don't believe growth and sustainability are separate questions."

KEY TAKEAWAY
VeliD Advisory exists because international growth built without a sustainability lens rarely holds. The Holland House Mexico track record proves that, so the brand doesn't need to declare it.

How VeliD Advisory positions itself

Nineteen years in Mexico, seven and a half of them leading the Dutch-Mexican Chamber of Commerce, taught Carin what makes international growth work and what quietly breaks it.

She has seen companies of every size succeed and fail abroad, which makes it easy to spot the common mistakes early: the wrong partner, an offer that was never adapted to the local market, a positioning that simply didn't land. She also knows that growth only holds if it is financially, socially, environmentally and organizationally future-proof, and she brings a wide network of professionals and organizations, built over two decades, into every project.

Three reasons companies choose VeliD

- Local knowledge and first-hand experience, not a report written from a distance.
- An extensive, cultivated network, deployed to help reach the company's own goals.
- A belief that lasting growth means putting economic, ecological and social impact, and sound governance, at the foundation, not added on afterward.

How VeliD Advisory sounds

The voice is warm, concrete and grounded in what actually happened, not in how impressive it can be made to sound.

In practice

Speak in the first person when describing experience and proof; Carin lived this, so the writing says “I,” not a distanced “VeliD Advisory” hiding the person behind it. Use “VeliD Advisory” when describing the offer itself, especially anywhere the firm may one day include other people. Every claim about the track record has to be accurate and checkable. If a number or an outcome can’t be confirmed, it doesn’t go in.

House rules

- No em dashes, ever, anywhere.
- No declarative self-promotion. Don’t say “I know these markets”; show what was built and let the reader conclude it.
- Avoid short, punchy sentences that read like they were generated to sound confident. Let sentences breathe and explain.
- Keep the register hands-on and specific: cultural training, market entry, a storyline, topicalization, not “leveraging synergies.”

KEY TAKEAWAY
Say what’s true, in a way that shows it happened. The brand doesn’t need to declare its own quality.

The mark

The primary logo is the full VeliD Advisory wordmark. The V and D carry the brand's two accent colors; the underscore after the D is part of the mark, not punctuation.

For small spaces (favicons, social avatars, watermarks) use the icon-only mark: the colored V-D monogram without the word "Advisory" beneath it.

On dark backgrounds

Use the reversed lockup, cream wordmark with the same coral and teal accents, on Navy. Never place the standard dark-text logo on a dark background, and never place the reversed light logo on a light background.

Rules

- Keep clear space around the mark at least the height of the "V."
- Never stretch, rotate, recolour, or add effects such as shadows or outlines to the logo.
- Don't place other text or graphics inside the clear space.
- The icon-only mark may stand alone. Don't crop the full wordmark to fit a small space; use the icon instead.

Color

Navy is the anchor, not the default text color. Teal carries secondary hierarchy, coral is reserved for sparing emphasis, and cream creates breathing room. Most body text stays dark grey.

COLOUR	HEX	USE
Navy	#1F3C54	Headings, primary text on light backgrounds, the anchor color
Coral	#EB937D	Sparing accent: a key word, a call to action, the D in the wordmark
Teal	#5D9382	Subheadings, labels, section numbers, the underscore in the wordmark
Cream	#FAF5EA	Backgrounds, the reversed logo's wordmark color on Navy

Use the Word Styles pane (see the Style Map on the last page) to apply these automatically rather than picking colors by eye.

Typography

Two typefaces carry the whole brand. Poppins for anything that leads, Montserrat for anything that explains.

Poppins SemiBold or Bold sets titles, headings, labels and short callouts, in Navy or Teal depending on the level. Montserrat Regular carries every paragraph of running text, lead paragraphs and captions, mostly in dark grey or muted tones, so Navy stays reserved for structure, not decoration.

The exact style-by-style breakdown is on the last page of this guide (VeliD Style Map). Apply styles from the Word Styles pane; don't set fonts and colors by hand.

Experience you can measure

Carin took over a network of 17 member companies at Holland House Mexico. When she left, it had grown to 120+ members and partners, and turnover had increased from 2.5 million to 11.4 million pesos.

She transformed a network originally built around oil and gas into a platform for sustainable trade. Membership naturally comes and goes over the years, but not one member left specifically because of that shift. That matters more than the numbers on their own: the change held because it was built with people, not imposed on them.

KEY TAKEAWAY
This is the proof that carries the brand. Lead with it wherever the audience needs to trust Carin before the first conversation, not with adjectives about how experienced she is.

What VeliD Advisory does

Apart from a relatively standard diagnostic report, there is no fixed package, because every company that comes to VeliD is in a different place. The shape of the work depends on what is actually needed, the stage the company is in, and the budget.

Areas of expertise

- Market entry: strategy and practical groundwork for entering a new country.
- Strategy and offer repositioning, including topicalization: adapting a product, service or story so it actually lands in a new market instead of arriving as a direct translation of what worked at home.
- Sustainability as a competitive advantage, not a compliance exercise.
- Cultural training, team workshops and speaking sessions on international business and cross-cultural collaboration.
- Network and introductions, built over two decades, deployed for the client instead of starting cold.

The process

Before we start	A free 30-minute introduction, to understand where the company is, where it wants to go, and whether there's a meaningful role for VeliD.
1. Diagnostic	Once the two sides decide to work together, a closer look at the current proposition, the opportunity, and what needs to happen to make it work.
2. Strategy & build	Depending on what the diagnostic reveals, this becomes a market entry strategy, a repositioning strategy, or another tailored approach. VeliD can stay involved as the strategy is put into practice.
3. Support & adjust	Strategic sparring, feedback, connections and hands-on support as things develop. Evaluate, learn and adjust along the way.

How the network works

VeliD Advisory is built on a network in Mexico and beyond, from institutions to individual specialists, connected through Netherlands Chambers International to Chambers of Commerce worldwide.

Independent collaborators bring specific expertise into a project when it calls for it. Each invoices the client directly and is introduced by name and specialism. They are not presented as VeliD team members, both because that is what the current legal structure requires and because it keeps the positioning honest: VeliD is Carin's practice, supported by a network, not a firm with staff it doesn't have.

KEY TAKEAWAY
Never write "our team" or "we" in a way that implies employees. Write "VeliD Advisory works with [name], who specializes in [x]" instead.

VeliD Style Map

Use the Word Styles pane rather than manually changing fonts and colours. The names below are the styles built into this template.

STYLE	FONT	COLOUR	USE
Title	Poppins Bold	Navy	Document title / cover only
Heading 1	Poppins SemiBold	Navy	Main section heading
Heading 2	Poppins SemiBold	Teal	Subsection heading
Heading 3	Poppins SemiBold	Teal	Small subsection
VeliD Label	Poppins SemiBold	Teal	Section numbers, labels, metadata
VeliD Lead	Montserrat Regular	Muted	Intro / lead paragraph
Normal / VeliD Body	Montserrat Regular	Dark grey	Main body copy
VeliD Quote	Montserrat Regular	Teal	Pull quote / principle
VeliD Callout	Poppins SemiBold	Navy	Short callout text
VeliD Caption	Montserrat Regular	Muted	Sources, captions, notes
Header	Poppins SemiBold	Teal	Small running header
Footer	Montserrat Regular	Muted	Footer + page number

color principle

Navy is the anchor, not the default text color. Teal carries secondary hierarchy; Coral is reserved for selective emphasis; Cream creates breathing room. Most body text stays dark grey.

CORAL ACCENT | Use sparingly for a key word, action, or important highlight.